

Max S. Bennett

Curriculum Vitae

Updated August 2026
max.bennett@columbia.edu
Google Scholar

EXPERIENCE

- Astera Institute**, Research Scientist (part-time, working on cortical microcircuits) 2026-
Thousand Brains Project, Board Member (reverse-engineering neocortical intelligence) 2025-
Bluecore, Co-Founder & Chief Product Officer (acquired by Insider One, 2026) 2013 - 2021; 2024 - 2026
Alby AI, Co-Founder & CEO (acquired by Bluecore, 2024) 2022 - 2024

EDUCATION

- Columbia University** 2026-
Ph.D. Student in Computer Science
Advised by Rich Zemel, David Blei, and Hong Namkoong
- Columbia University** 2026
M.S. in Computer Science
GPA: 4.17 / 4.0
- Washington University in St. Louis** 2012
B.A. in Economics and Mathematics, *summa cum laude*
Distinction in Economics; Dean's List, all eligible terms; GPA: 3.90 / 4.0

BOOKS

- [1] **A Brief History of Intelligence: Evolution, AI, and the Five Breakthroughs That Made Our Brains** 2023
Mariner
M.S. Bennett

PAPERS

- [5] **Tell Me What To Learn: Generalizing Neural Memory to be Controllable in Natural Language** 2026
arXiv preprint
M.S. Bennett, T. Zollo, R. Zemel
- [4] **Five Breakthroughs: A First Approximation of Brain Evolution From Early Bilaterians to Humans** 2021
Frontiers in Neuroanatomy
M.S. Bennett
- [3] **What Behavioral Abilities Emerged at Key Milestones in Human Brain Evolution? 13 Hypotheses on the 600-Million-Year Phylogenetic History of Human Intelligence** 2021
Frontiers in Psychology
M.S. Bennett
- [2] **The Thalamus as a Blackboard for Perception and Planning** 2021
Frontiers in Behavioral Neuroscience
R. Worden, M.S. Bennett, V. Neacsu
- [1] **An Attempt at a Unified Theory of the Neocortical Microcircuit in Sensory Cortex** 2020
Frontiers in Neural Circuits
M.S. Bennett

PATENTS

- [3] **Smart campaign with autopilot features** 2023
U.S. Patent No. 11847671B2. Assigned to Bluecore, Inc.
B. Estes, A. Tunnell, S. Papa, M. Bennett, J. Hou, F. Fraioli, C. Chau, B. Shah, Z. Karam
- [2] **Automatic frequency capping** 2022
U.S. Patent No. 11270340. Assigned to Bluecore, Inc.
G. Knodel, S. Collet, C. Huang, Z. Karam, B. Estes, M. Bennett
- [1] **Experience optimization** 2022
U.S. Patent No. 11238502. Assigned to Bluecore, Inc.
S. Collet, Z. Karam, G. Knodel, M. Hurwitz, V. Leung, B. Shah, A. Tunnell, M. Bennett, B. Estes

AWARDS & HONORS

- Forbes 30 Under 30** 2017
- John M. Olin Prize for Excellence in Economics** Washington University in St. Louis 2012
- Omicron Delta Epsilon Economics Honors Society** Washington University in St. Louis 2012

INVITED TALKS

- “The Five ‘Breakthroughs’ in the 600-Million-Year Evolution of Human Intelligence”**
Computational and Systems Neuroscience (Cosyne), Montreal (Keynote) 2024
- “How NeuroAI Can Benefit From Evolutionary Neuroscience”**
From Neuroscience to Artificially Intelligent Systems (NAISys), Cold Spring Harbor Laboratory 2024
- “The Evolution of Human Intelligence: Why It Matters and What It Teaches Us About Ourselves, Neuroscience, and AI”**
Goldlab Symposium, University of Colorado Boulder 2024

ETC

- Programming:**
Python, C#, PyTorch (distributed training & inference with DDP), Git, DVC, Weights & Biases, Hugging Face
- Misc:**
Public speaking; original jazz composition; video game development (Unity, C#); long-form improv comedy